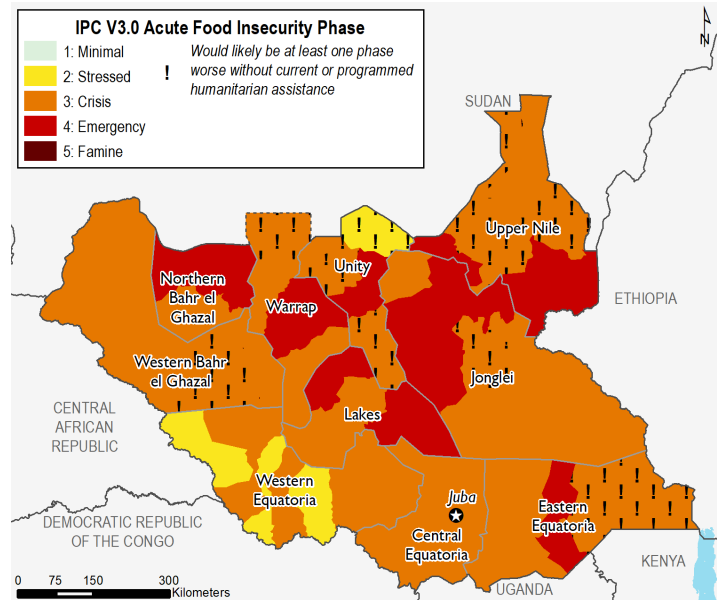


Risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) persists, though slight improvements expected with reduced conflict

KEY MESSAGES

- Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persist throughout South Sudan, and some households are likely in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).¹ According to the [May IPC analysis](#), an estimated 6.96 million people are estimated to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes through the July/August peak of the lean season in the presence of already planned humanitarian assistance. Food security will improve somewhat in late 2019 with the harvest, though Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes will remain widespread. A risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will also persist.
- Conflict has remained relatively low over the past year when compared with the level of conflict between 2014 and early 2018. This has supported greater household movement, higher engagement in planting, lower levels of new displacement, and some stabilization in the currency. It is anticipated that 2019/2020 production, starting in September, will be better than production in 2018/2019, though still below pre-crisis levels. These improvements are expected to support Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes in some counties, though Crisis (IPC Phase 3) will persist in most, and several counties will continue to face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes.

Current food security outcomes, June 2019



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

- Humanitarian food assistance is preventing more extreme outcomes in many areas of greatest concern and the likely continuation of assistance throughout the projection period is anticipated to prevent more widespread Emergency (IPC Phase 4). However, the number of beneficiaries reached with humanitarian food assistance remains far below the estimated need and slightly lower than the same time last year. A scale-up of assistance far above currently planned levels is needed throughout the projection period to prevent the loss of lives and livelihoods.
- Despite the decline in conflict and expected slight improvement in the food security situation, many households have lost key livelihood assets and strategies to cope with food insecurity as a result of the persistent conflict. The loss of key assets and livelihood options will continue to drive high levels of acute food insecurity, and a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist in South Sudan. Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely in the event that conflict shifts such that it prevents populations from moving in search of food sources and restricts humanitarian access for a prolonged period of time.

¹ 1 According to the IPC, a Famine (IPC Phase 5) has occurred when at least 20 percent of households in a given area have an extreme lack of food, the Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) prevalence, as measured by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ), exceeds 30 percent, and mortality, as measured by the Crude Death Rate (CDR), is greater than 2 per 10,000 per day. Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is when a household group has an extreme lack of food and/or other basic needs even with the full employment of coping strategies.

Lower conflict will support slight food security improvements, though the risk of Famine will persist

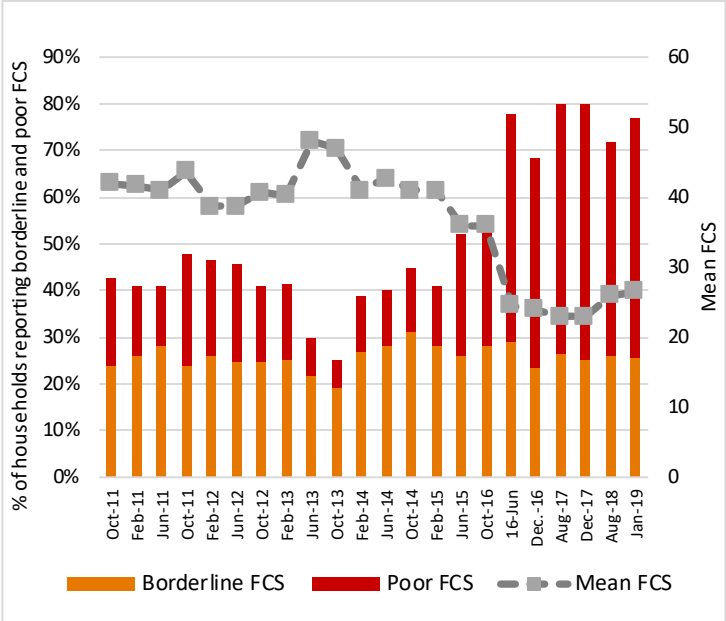
An **IPC update** conducted in May found that extreme levels of acute food insecurity persist across South Sudan, with nearly 7 million people estimated to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes between May and July 2019 in the presence of ongoing and planned humanitarian assistance. This estimate includes roughly 1.82 million people in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and 21,000 people in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Cuiet of Lakes, Canal/Pigi of Jonglei, and Panyikang or Upper Nile.

These outcomes highlight the continuous high levels of acute food insecurity across South Sudan. Food consumption indicators have shown persistent deterioration since the start of the conflict in late 2013, with the majority of the population now reporting a borderline or poor food consumption score (FCS) with the mean FCS of 25, dropping from over 40 prior to the conflict (Figure 1). Household Hunger Scale also indicates continued high reporting of moderate and severe hunger. Humanitarian food assistance is mitigating more extreme outcomes in many areas across the country; however, the reach of assistance remains far below the estimated need.

Food security is expected to improve in late 2019 as relatively lower levels of conflict in the past year have supported greater household movement, improved trade flows, and the resumption – to some degree – of typical livelihood activities including planting and fishing. It is anticipated that 2019/20 harvest, starting in September, will be better than production in 2018/19, the first time since the onset of the conflict that it has been expected national production would improve relative to the preceding year. By late 2019, after the ongoing lean season, these improvements are expected to support Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes in some areas of the country, though Crisis (IPC Phase 3) will remain widespread and several counties will continue to face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Should there be an absence of humanitarian assistance during this time period, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes would be more prevalent.

Despite the decline in conflict and expected slight food security improvements, years of active conflict have eroded the capacity of many households’ to cope (Figure 2), and the loss of these strategies and many household assets will continue to drive high levels of acute food insecurity even with improved production and greater household movement. Additionally, the risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist given the already high levels of acute food insecurity and the possibility for conflict to shift. Past trends indicate that conflict can shift quickly in South Sudan and food security deteriorates sharply when conflict restricts household movement and humanitarian access. Should this worst-case scenario occur, Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely. Full implementation of the September 2018 peace deal and an end to the conflict is needed for long-term food security improvements and to end the persistent risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in South Sudan. A scale-up in humanitarian food assistance is needed currently and throughout the projection period to prevent the loss of lives and livelihoods.

Figure 1. Food Consumption Score in South Sudan, October 2011 to January 2019



Source: FSNMS 11 - 23

Figure 2. Reporting of livelihood coping and exhaustion of coping options, December 2018-January 2019

In the last 30 days did your household [...] because of a lack of food or money to buy food	Yes	No, I have already engaged in this activity in the last 12 mos. and cannot continue doing it
[send more household members than normal to cattle and/or fishing camps because of a lack of food or money to buy food?]	14.2%	9.9%
[sell more animals than normal for this time of year]	16.1%	12.0%
[borrow money or purchase food on credit more than usual during this time of year]	20.2%	69.2%
[Asked community members for support]	18.3%	16.8%

Source: FSNMS 23

NATIONAL OVERVIEW

Current Situation

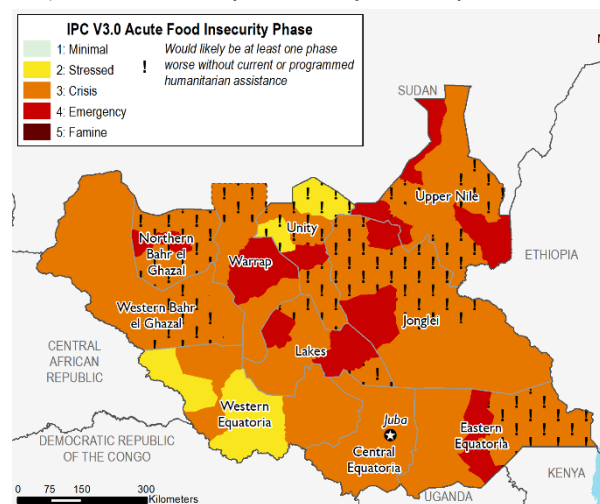
Data collected in the 23rd round of the Food Security and Nutrition Monitoring System (FSNMS) and rapid assessments conducted by FEWS NET and partners indicated that extreme levels of acute food insecurity persisted in January. Nationally, 51 percent of the population reported a poor Food Consumption Score (FCS) and 61 percent reported moderate hunger on the Household Hunger Scale (HHS) in early 2019. Additionally, an estimated 50 percent of the population reported engaging in at least one coping strategy indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) due to a lack of food or money to purchase food. Overall, these outcomes, corroborated by rapid assessments, indicated widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) during the post-harvest period.

An [IPC update](#) conducted in May found food security had deteriorated somewhat during the ongoing lean season. The analysis estimated 6.96 million people (61% of the population) face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse acute food insecurity in the presence of humanitarian assistance, among whom 1.82 million people are in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and 21,000 people are in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

The ongoing implementation of the September 2018 peace deal has significantly lowered active conflict in 2019 relative to 2014-2018 in many areas of Greater Upper Nile, Greater Bahr el Ghazal and some parts of Greater Equatoria (Figure 3). This has led to some improvement in trade flows and the recovery of market functioning and encouraged the return of some IDPs and refugees to their areas of origins. Despite these improvements, armed and inter-communal conflict persists in parts of the country, including in Lakes, Kapoeta East, Pibor, Twic, and Yei, and has resulted in [the loss of lives, displacement](#), disruption along [trade routes](#), and has restricted farming and other key livelihood activities. Furthermore, despite the current decline in conflict events, the last five years of active conflict have resulted in the loss of some livelihood options, household assets, and erosion of households' capacity to cope – all of which continue to drive high levels of acute food insecurity in the country.

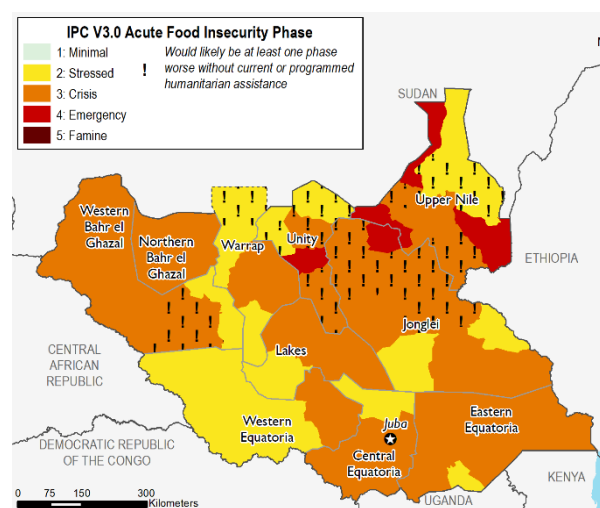
The displacement of farming households, periodic restrictions to farmland and agriculture inputs, and occasionally poor rainfall performance negatively impacted 2018/19 production. Based on the 2018/2019 Crop and Food Supply Assessment mission estimates (CFSAM), production decreased by 2.5 percent from 2017/2018, resulting in a national cereal gap that was 10.6 percent greater than the previous year. This production was also 15.4 percent lower than the five-year average. Data collected during the 23rd FSNMS indicated roughly 70 percent of households planted cereals countrywide in 2018, though 66 percent of them reported stock lasting only 1-6 months, compared to the 7 months typical of pre-crisis years. Consequently, it is expected that most households do not currently have stocks from the harvest. This is further supported by the findings of rapid assessments conducted by FEWS NET in Pibor, Kapoeta, Pigi/Canal, Panyikang, Fangak, Cueibet, Rumbek North, Yirol East, and Yei between February and May 2019, which found most households had already exhausted food stocks from own production and were relying on markets, wild foods, and humanitarian assistance where available.

Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2019 to January 2020

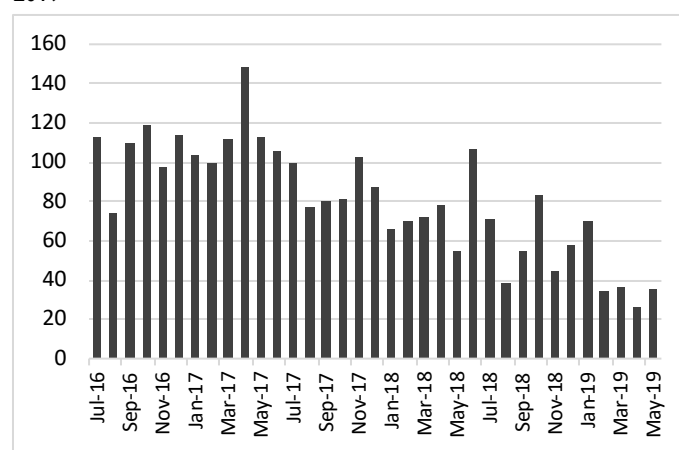


Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is [IPC-compatible](#). IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

Macroeconomic conditions throughout the country have remained poor and continue to be characterized by high inflation and unemployment. This is despite increases in [non-oil revenue](#) collection and an increase in oil exports from 135,000 barrels per day (bpd) in November 2018 to [175,000 bpd](#) in May 2019. Despite increased hard currency earnings from oil exports, much of this revenue is already allocated to infrastructure development, logistics of the implementation of the peace agreement, and the repayment of loans. As a result, traders' and service providers' access to foreign currency to import consumer goods and provide basic public services remains very low. The gradual improvement of hard currency earnings has helped maintain the exchange rate somewhat, though, at high levels between 275 to 280 South Sudanese Pounds (SSP) per U.S. Dollar (USD) on the parallel market. The official exchange rate remains at around 156 SSP/USD in mid-May 2019.

Figure 3. Number of reported conflict incidents, July 2016 to May 2019



Source: ACLED

Trade flows and market functioning have improved somewhat in 2019 given lower levels of conflict (Figure 4). Key informant information indicated trade flow from Sudan to Wau and Raga; White Nile State to Fashoda and Leer; Bentiu and Rumbek to Central Unity; Ethiopia to Pagak; and Juba-Bor-Adok in Leer via the Nile River are all operating with minimum disruption. This is in addition to improvements observed in trade flows along the Nimule-Juba road, the main supply route into the country, and trade volumes in the first quarter of 2019 have improved relative to the previous quarter and the same quarter last year.

However, due to below average production and currency depreciation, market supplies across most of the country remain lower than pre-crisis levels, and prices of staple food are extremely high (Figure 5). According to price data from [CLiMIS](#), the retail price of white sorghum in Juba in May 2019 was 74 percent lower than last year, but 147 percent higher than the five-year average. Similarly, in Wau, the price of sorghum in April was 76 percent lower than last year, but 173 percent higher than five-year average. In Aweil Centre, the price of sorghum was 78 percent lower than last year, but 250 percent higher than the five-year average. In Juba, prices have remained below last year for several months. In Wau and Aweil, the price drop below last year's prices is anticipated to be temporary and attributed to increased assistance delivery and the release of stocks by traders. Prices remain above both last year and the five-year average in most rural markets.

Figure 4. Market and trade functioning map, June 2019

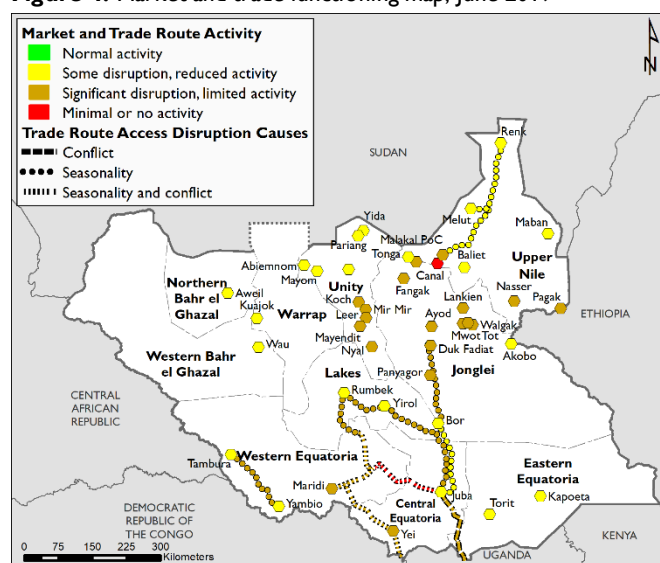
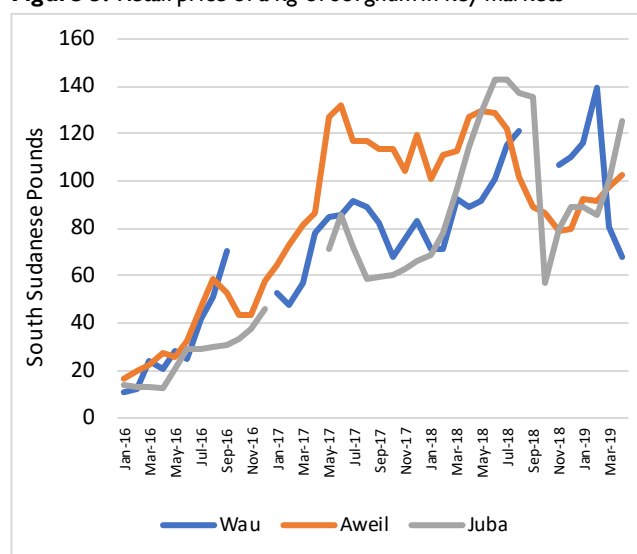


Figure 5. Retail price of a kg of sorghum in key markets

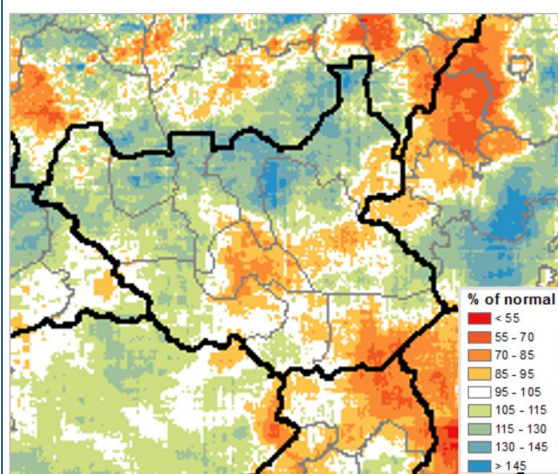


The onset of March to May first season rains in bimodal Greater Equatoria was 10-30 days late; in most areas rains started in early to mid-April and were characterized by poor spatial distribution and below-average totals. Rainfall increased in May, though deficits persisted at the end of the season in several areas (Figure 6). The delayed start of rains led to delayed planting of maize and groundnuts crops. Ground information from key informants indicates that 15 to 45 percent of planted cereal crops in Equatoria are currently in different vegetative stages of growth. Overall the area planted is similar to last year but remains below pre-crisis levels due to continued insecurity limiting access to farmlands in some areas and poor seasonal progress. Conversely, in northern unimodal rainfall areas the start of rains was early or timely. In Central Upper Nile and Bahr-el Ghazal regions, land preparation and some planting are ongoing.

Throughout the country humanitarian access has somewhat improved in areas previously inaccessible in Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal. Many areas continue to be reached with emergency assistance: between January and April, between 1 and 2 million people were reached with humanitarian food assistance, specifically general food distributions (GFD) or food for assets programs (FFA). It is expected that this assistance continues to mitigate more severe outcomes in many areas of concern in Greater Upper Nile, Greater Bahr el Ghazal and some parts of Greater Equatoria. However, the population reached with assistance remains well below the roughly 7.7 million people expected to be in need of humanitarian food assistance (Figure 7).

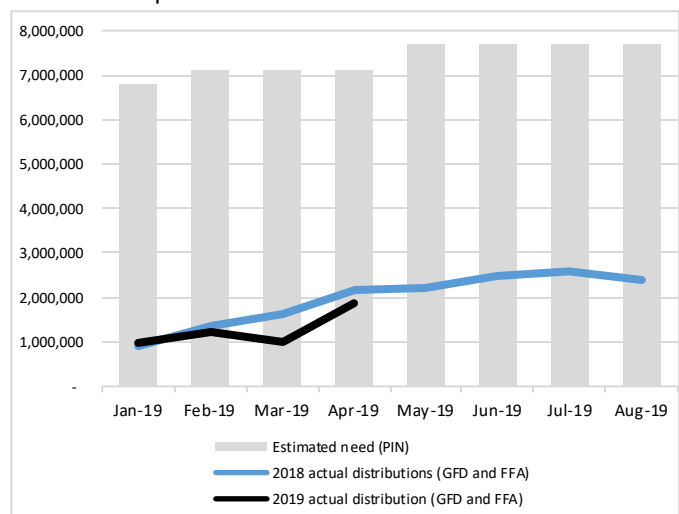
As a result of the erosion of livelihoods throughout the protracted conflict including the loss of livelihood assets, as well as extremely high food prices, exhaustion of harvests, and some restriction to wild foods, many households continue to face difficulty meeting their basic food needs and high levels of acute food insecurity persist. SMART surveys conducted between January and April 2019 corroborate likely high levels of acute food insecurity: the SMART surveys recorded a 'Serious' (10.0-14.9%) to 'Critical' (15.0-29.9%) Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) prevalence by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ) (Figure 8). It is expected Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persist throughout the country and Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are anticipated in areas of greatest concern including Panyikang of Upper Nile, Cueibet of Lakes, and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei. In several areas, humanitarian food assistance continues to prevent more extreme outcomes and Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) is likely, notably in areas of Greater Upper Nile, Greater Bahr el Ghazal, and parts of Eastern Equatoria.

Figure 6. Rainfall as a percentage of normal, March 1 – May 30, 2019, CHIRPS



Source: USGS/FEWS NET

Figure 7. Estimated population in need of humanitarian food assistance compared to deliveries of GFD and FFA



Source: WFP and IPC data

Figure 8. Results from SMART surveys collected between Jan and April 2019

County	GAM (WHZ)	SAM (WHZ)	Non-trauma CDR
Aweil west	12.7% (10.6-15.0)	2.5% (1.6-3.9)	0.15
Aweil north	12.6% (10.1-15.5)	1.7% (1.0-3.0)	0.20
Duk	21.5% (17.8-25.8)	5.5% (3.5-10.0)	0.26
Juba PoC	16.4% (13.5-19.7)	3.4% (2.3-5.0)	0.26
Guit	11.7% (8.8-15.4)	2.2% (1.3-2.8)	0.15
Bentiu PoC	14.7% (11.4-18.7)	1.9% (1.1-3.4)	0.28
Cueibet	12.4% (10.2-15.0)	2.6% (1.6-4.1)	0.60
Canal Pigi	24.3% (19.5-29.8)	6.7% (4.7-9.7)	0.76

Source: Nutrition Information Working Group

National Assumption:

The June 2019 to January 2020 most likely scenario is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- Conflict is likely to be lower than that observed between 2014 and 2018 based on recent trends and given the ongoing peace deal implementation and continued involvement of IGAD and the international community. However, some conflict events and insecurity are still likely in areas of Greater Equatoria and Greater Upper Nile and, to a lesser extent, in Western Bahr el Ghazal. In Lakes, Warrap, and Jonglei, cattle-raiding and inter-communal conflict are also anticipated.
- Given likely lower levels of conflict, new internal displacements are expected to be relatively low. Some returnees are expected from Sudan and Ethiopia based on current trends. Returnees are also likely from Uganda and the DRC, though the number of returnees from these countries is likely to be low as insecurity still persists along the borders with these countries. Internally, some IDPs are likely to return to their areas of origins, especially from Bentiu, Malakal and Wau PoCs. Overall, the number of displaced persons will remain high.
- Based on forecasts from NOAA and USGS, rainfall from June to September is forecast to be above average. This is expected to result in an overall above-average main rainy season in Greater Bahr el Ghazal and Greater Upper Nile. Despite early season rainfall deficits in Greater Equatoria, the recovery of rainfall late in the season and forecast above-average rainfall during the second rainy season is anticipated to result in overall above-average rainfall in 2019. Some flooding is likely in flood-prone areas of the country, primarily areas of Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal.
- In Greater Equatoria, due to the poor start of season, June/July first season production is expected to be lower than last year and pre-crisis levels. However, above-average rainfall through September and relatively better access to planting is likely to result in higher production during the November/December second season in Greater Equatoria and main season in northern areas relative to last year. Nationally, 2019/20 production is likely to be slightly better than 2018/19 production, but still below pre-crisis levels.
- The availability of fish and wild foods is expected to increase seasonally through September, and total availability is expected to be above average in northern areas given the forecast of above average rainfall. Insecurity is still expected to periodically limit access to these food sources, though to a lesser degree than that which occurred between 2016-2018 when conflict was relatively higher.
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections, staple food prices in markets outside of Juba, including Wau, Rumbek Center, Bor South, and Aweil, are expected to be higher than 2018 prices, between 100 and 200 SSP/kg. High prices are expected as a result of continued slight currency depreciation, periodic conflict-related disruptions to trade, and continued high transportation costs. Staple food prices in Juba are expected to remain below 2018 prices, between 85 and 115 SSP/kg, due to the local harvest and likely increased trade flows through Nimule.
- Trade and market functioning are expected to improve relative to last year; however, in areas where insecurity will likely persist, trade flows will intermittently be disrupted. Imports from Uganda are expected to be higher than last year as security along the Juba-Nimule road improves traders' confidence. Given persistent poor macroeconomic conditions in Sudan, it is expected that imports from Sudan will remain similar or slightly lower than the first quarter of 2019.
- Macroeconomic conditions are expected to improve slightly with continued lower levels of conflict and likely increasing oil production that is expected to be somewhat above current levels, though still below pre-crisis levels of 350,000 bpd. It is expected that this and ongoing efforts to increase the non-oil revenues, will moderate the rate of depreciation of the SSP, though the local currency is still expected to fluctuate between 250 and 300 SSP/USD during the outlook period.
- Based on WFP's updated operational plan and past humanitarian assistance delivery trends, it is expected that humanitarian food assistance through GFD and FFA will reach between 1.8 and 2.5 million people monthly during the June to September period. Also based on plans, past trends, and the expectation of a harvest at this time, the monthly reach of assistance is anticipated to be lower during the October to December period, reaching between 1 and 1.5 million people per month. The assistance delivery assumed above is somewhat lower than plans due to the likely periodic access and budgetary constraints. On average households are expected to be reached with a 33 to 50 percent of their monthly kilocalorie needs.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Food security outcomes are likely to deteriorate further through the July/August peak of the lean season with the seasonal decline in food availability and access. Many households will continue to face difficulty purchasing sufficient food given that prices remain extremely high despite some declines in recent months. Furthermore, the erosion of livelihoods over time has left many households with few or no livestock and lower assets with which to engage in cultivation. Food security will improve slightly towards the end of the first projection period with the arrival of green harvests in late-August/September and seasonal increases in the availability of fish, waterlilies, livestock products, and wild greens. Overall, though, widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected to persist during this time, with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Panyikang of Upper Nile, Canal/Pigi of Jonglei and Cueibet of Lakes. In addition to these counties, areas of greatest concern include Rumbek North and Yirol East of Lakes; Leer, Mayendit, and Koch of Central Unity; Raga and Wau of Western Bahr el Ghazal; and Kapoeta East of Eastern Equatoria. The prevalence of acute malnutrition is expected to deteriorate, though remain between 'Serious' and 'Critical' levels.

Between October 2019 and January 2020, food security is expected to improve with the dry harvest, greater increases in livestock production, and continued availability of fish and wild foods. Seasonally lower food prices will improve food access relative to the lean season, though still continue to restrict normal food access across the country. Improvements to household movement, trade flows, and production are expected to drive slightly better food security outcomes than have been projected in South Sudan in recent years, though widespread Crisis (IPC phase 3) outcomes are still likely, with several areas of greatest concern likely to remain in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Additionally, more widespread Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes would be likely even during this post-harvest period in the absence of the assistance that is likely to be delivered throughout the projection period. A risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) will persist in South Sudan; Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be likely in the event that conflict shifts and severely limits household movement and humanitarian access.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	No implementation of the signed peace deal that in turn leads to an uptick in conflict	This would likely restrict household movement, including towards markets and wild foods, increase displacement, and lower the delivery of humanitarian assistance. As was observed between 2016 and 2018, more widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes, and an increased number of households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), would be likely across seasons. The concern for the likelihood of Famine (IPC Phase 5) would increase in areas of heavy conflict.
National	Scale-up in oil production and exports; increase in other sources of foreign currency earnings	This would increase the availability of foreign currency and although some of these earnings would continue to go to loan repayment, some earnings would likely be available for increased importation of basic goods and increased spending on public services. The SSP would also likely appreciate slightly, resulting in better food access through lower food prices. Food security outcomes would likely improve slightly, though widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes would persist.

AREAS OF CONCERN:

Upper Nile and Jonglei states: Panyikang, Fangak and Canal/Pigi (Figure 9)

Current Situation

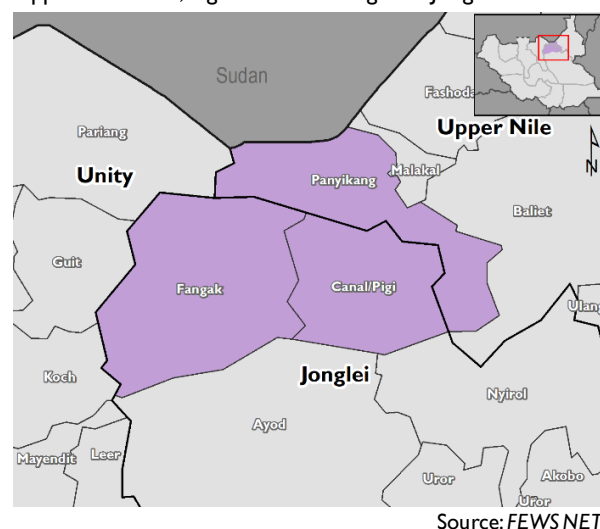
Data collected during the 23rd FSNMS showed extreme levels of food insecurity in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang during the post-harvest period. In both counties, over 75 percent of households reported a poor FCS and over 20 percent reported severe HHS, with 12-13 percent reporting an HHS indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Rapid assessments and data collection during the lean season indicate these extreme levels of acute food insecurity have likely persisted through June, despite relatively lower levels of conflict. Outcomes were somewhat less severe in Fangak, where 46 percent of households reported a poor FCS and 6 percent reported severe hunger. However, Fangak is an area of concern due to the high number of recently arrived returnees.

Relative calm has persisted in 2019 in the counties of concern and no large-scale internal displacements have occurred between January and May. However, significant displacement occurred between April and December 2018 and the number

of the internally displaced persons remains similar to last year in Canal/Pigi and Fangak: in Canal/Pigi 13,466 people remain displaced and in Fangak 15,525 people remain displaced. In Panyikang, the number of people displaced has declined to 12,028 people, down from 28,200 people in April 2018, and it is expected some of the displaced returned to Tonga or Canal/Pigi.

There have also been a number of returnees to these counties. A rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in mid-May in Deil and Atar payams of Canal/Pigi found that an estimated 1,750 persons reported returning from southwestern Malakal and North Sudan between March and May 2019. Additionally, an estimated 2,300 individuals mostly coming from Liri and Sunguru camps of White Nile in North Sudan have also recently arrived Tonga. Field information indicates that the number of returnees coming to Tonga Town of Panyikang is increasing on daily basis, though some of these newly returned households are proceeding to their places of origin in Fangak and Canal/Pigi. Households report returning due to relative calm, as well as a lack of water and food in refugee camps, though many still lack sufficient access to food and productive assets in their areas of origin.

Figure 9. Areas of concern reference map: Panyikang of Upper Nile State, Pigi/Canal and Fangak of Jonglei State



The majority of the households have already depleted cereal stocks from the 2018/19 production. In Panyikang, data from FSNMS indicated only 11 percent of households harvested cereals sufficient to last 1- 4 months, and none of the surveyed households reported that stocks would last beyond 5 months. In a typical year, food stocks normally last for 6.5 months in Panyikang, which falls within the Sorghum and Livestock livelihood zone. Similarly, most households' stocks in Canal/Pigi were estimated to last under 4 months. In Fangak, only 3 percent of the surveyed households reported during FSNMS that their harvests would last for 5 to 6 months, while the rest reported it would last for fewer months, and this is compared to 9 months which is typical of counties in the Eastern Plains and Cattle livelihood zone.

Markets are operating at minimal levels in all the counties of concern, though relatively better than last year, and recent years given that relative calm has permitted some recovery of trade flows and markets functioning. In Panyikang, Tonga market has recovered and is supplying markets in New Fangak, Deil and Atar of Canal/Pigi, and Old Fangak. In Tonga market, red and white sorghum are available, though prices are high at around 100 SSP/kg. Additionally, rice, beans, salt, sugar, and cooking oil are available in the market at low levels. However, in Pakang, Dhothim, Nyilwal, Panyidwai, and Nakdiar of Panyikang, markets are poorly functioning, and households have difficulty accessing Tonga market due to the long physical distance. In Canal/Pigi, Deil market is functioning but with limited cereals; only a few food items such as onion, rice, and cooking oil are available. In Atar of Canal/Pigi, no market is available, and the population must travel over an hour by boat to access the market in Deil. In Fangak, market functioning is relatively better, with higher volumes of basic commodities coming from Malakal and Sudan via Tonga as safety along trade routes has improved.

A rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in the counties of concern in mid-May corroborated FSNMS findings that livestock ownership remains very low in Panyikang and Canal/Pigi. Among those who do own livestock, livestock remain in dry season grazing areas and access to milk in June is low. Livestock ownership is somewhat higher in Fangak, where nearly 70 percent of households reported owning livestock. The same rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in mid-May indicates that households have increased their reliance on fish and wild foods, though these food sources are seasonally at their lowest levels and insecurity periodically limits collection. Additionally, many households do not own fishing gear, particularly newly returned households.

The June to September rains started on time and rainfall performance has been average, though its progression is erratic over time. Households in Deil of Canal/Pigi, where most people within the county live, have completed land preparation, though rainfall totals are not yet sufficient to support the planting of crops. In Panyikang, households have prepared land for cultivation in most locations including Achar and Tonga, and an estimated 6,500 farmers received seeds and tools from World Vision distributions. Additionally, some households have planted vegetable at the river side. This is the first seed and tool distribution to this area, supported by the relative calm. In Fangak, land preparation and planting are also underway.

Between February and April, roughly 30 percent of the population was reached monthly, on average, in Fangak, and roughly 15 percent of the population was reached monthly, on average, in Panyikang. In Pigi/Canal, no assistance was delivered between these months. In counties that received assistance, the ration was over 50 percent. A rapid assessment conducted by FEWS NET in mid-May in these counties indicated that assistance is not reaching many newly returned households directly, though many of those who are hosting returnees are sharing their humanitarian food assistance. In Fangak assistance deliveries have been consistent between February and April, whereas they have been relatively inconsistent in Panyikang.

Food security outcomes were already indicative of widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) during the post-harvest period and information available through June indicates outcomes have remained similar or deteriorated somewhat. In Pigi/Canal, a SMART survey conducted in early April by IMC found a GAM (WHZ) prevalence of 24.3 percent (19.5-29.8) and Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) of 6.7 percent (4.6-9.7), indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Additionally, Nile Hope reported during a screening that 2 children in Deil of Canal/Pigi had a MUAC less than 11 mm, indicative of SAM, and these children were transferred to Kurwai for treatment. In Panyikang, nutrition partners reported an increase of acute malnutrition cases especially among returnees, and in the first week of May World Vision conducted a screening and found 6 children with MAUC less than 11.5 mm, indicative of SAM.

These above assessment findings and available outcomes corroborate continued high levels of acute food insecurity driven by no food stocks, limited livestock holdings, and poor market access. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely in Panyikang and Canal/Pigi and some households are likely in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). These households are expected to be those with no livestock, limited or no access to farmlands and markets, and who are reporting of severe hunger. In Fangak, where assets are somewhat higher and deliveries of assistance are high and consistent, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are likely.

Assumptions:

In addition to the above national-level assumptions, projected outcomes for the counties of concern in Upper Nile and Jonglei are based on the following assumptions:

- In all counties of concern, relative calm is expected, though insecurity is likely to persist in remote areas. This will likely limit the recovery of markets, trade flows, and household movement in search of wild foods and fish.
- Prices will likely remain high due to expectation of low production and limited trade flows from Sudan and Malakal. Prices are expected to remain extremely high in Tonga of Panyikang and Deil and Atar of Canal/Pigi due to high cost of transportation from source markets.
- Based on forecast for above-average June to September rainfall, flooding is likely in lower parts of Canal/Pigi and Fangak during the peak rainy months of August-September. Flooding is likely to destroy some crops and homesteads. However, given the relative calm prevailing in the areas of concerns and some access to agricultural inputs, it's still expected that harvests during the 2019/20 season will be higher than 2018/19, and still lower than pre-crisis levels.
- It is anticipated income earning opportunities will remain lower than pre-crisis levels based on data from the most recent FSNMS in which slightly under half of households in these counties reported the loss of employment and over a third reported a decrease in income; it is expected the broader macroeconomic conditions will continue to limit full recovery of income sources.
- In all the counties of concern, humanitarian food assistance has been planned at least periodically through December 2019. In Panyikang and Canal/Pigi, assistance is planned to reach under 20 percent of the population monthly, with roughly 50 percent of their monthly kilocalorie needs, during both projection periods. In Fangak, assistance is planned to reach between 60 and 75 percent of the population monthly with roughly 35 percent of their monthly kilocalorie needs during both projection periods. Based on past trends, it is expected that the delivery of assistance will be relatively consistently in Fangak, whereas deliveries will be relatively inconsistent in Pigi/Canal and Panyikang.
- Poor households are expected to engage in collection and sales of natural resources such as firewood and charcoal during the projection period, with collection and sales at their highest levels between the November to January dry season.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

High levels of acute food insecurity are expected to persist through the July/August peak of the lean season, with the most extreme outcomes likely in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang. During this time households will continue to rely on fish, wild foods, markets, and humanitarian assistance where available. Although market access has improved, high prices will still limit households' ability to purchase sufficient food. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcome expected to persist in Panyikang and Canal/Pigi, with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes will likely persist in Fangak. Food security will improve between October and January among households who were able to plant and harvested, and food security will improve among most due to the increased availability of fish, wild foods, and wild game. These improvements are expected to be limited by occasional insecurity that will restrict movement, as well as continued high food prices and, for some households, no physical access to markets. Although assistance will continue to mitigate more extreme outcomes, delivery is likely to be inconsistent and relatively low in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are in these counties. Given that expectation of relative calm would enable relatively better access to assistance and wild foods, some harvests, and sharing of livestock products, Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are not expected during this time. Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) is expected to persist in Fangak.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
Panyikang of Upper Nile and Fangak and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei	Increased armed conflict	Increased conflict would limit access to assistance, fish, wild foods, and the degree to which markets recover. Additional displacement would also be likely. Households would face even greater difficulty accessing foods, increasing the number of households likely in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) across the three counties, and in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Canal/Pigi and Panyikang, throughout the projection period.

Lakes: Cueibet, Rumbek North and Yirol East (Figure 10)

Current Situation:

In the three counties of concern, the impact of inter-communal conflict and cattle raiding between 2017 and 2019 has disrupted livelihoods and access to grazing areas, fishing grounds, and markets, displaced households, and altogether driven high levels of acute food insecurity. According to data collected during the 23rd FSNMS, 50 percent households in Yirol East reported a poor FCS and 88 percent reported moderate HHS, indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes, with 4 percent reporting severe hunger indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Cueibet, 91 percent households reported poor FCS and 26 percent reported severe hunger, indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes with 10 percent reporting severe hunger indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Rumbek North, 50 percent of households reported poor FCS and 88 percent reporting moderate HHS, indicative of area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. In all of the counties of concern, under 10 percent of households were engaged in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) coping, though a high percentage was engaged in one or more Crisis (IPC Phase 3) strategies. Rapid assessments and partner information indicates these extreme levels of acute food insecurity have likely persisted through June.

In Rumbek North, 23,400 people were displaced internally in Alor and to Yirol East and Rumbek Center between mid-2016 and mid-2019. An IRNA assessment in Maper in March 2019 reported high levels of illness among IDPs and returnees: 392 cases of malaria, 68 cases of diarrhea, and 261 cases of acute respiratory infections. In Yirol East, an OCHA assessment indicated displacement declined from 37,290 people in December 2018 to 25,682 people in March 2019, as some of those displaced from Rumbek North noted above were reportedly forcefully returned to their areas of origin. Displaced populations face continuous insecurity that is limiting access to fishing grounds and markets. In May, counter-raiding in Yirol East resulted in the loss of 445 herds of cattle from the displaced Pakam community and restricted access to fishing grounds in Shambe and livestock grazing areas.

In Cueibet, according to a household survey conducted in late 2018 by AVIS, an Italian Agency for Development Cooperation, 65 percent of assessed households reported that livelihood conditions had worsened from September 2018, especially in

Tiap-tiap and Malou Pec, due to poor rainfall (44%), persistent high prices (21%), and the loss of harvest/crop (15%). As a direct result of this worsening situation, 20,000 persons have reportedly migrated and settled in other areas of Cueibet due to hunger (25%). This increase in displacement is corroborated by a UN-OCHA displacement report that indicated a 24.7 percent increase in displacement in Cueibet from 8,869 people in December 2018 to 11,065 people in March 2019.

In addition to inter-communal conflict, cereal production in the three areas of concern has continuously declined over the last four years. The 2018 CFSAM reported 60-88 percent of households had access to land and planted, though cereal was well below requirements and farming households are likely harvesting much less per household than prior to the conflict. Between the 2017/2018 and 2018/2019, production declined slightly in Rumbek North, driving up the cereal gap from 2,631 MT to 2,710 MT. In Cueibet, production declined from 4,210 MT to only 68 MT. Conversely, in Yirol East, the cereal gap decreased slightly from 2,199 MT to 1,846 MT. Low production in Rumbek North and Cueibet is linked to continuous inter-communal violence and displacement of farming households, a prolonged dry spell, and limited access to agricultural inputs.

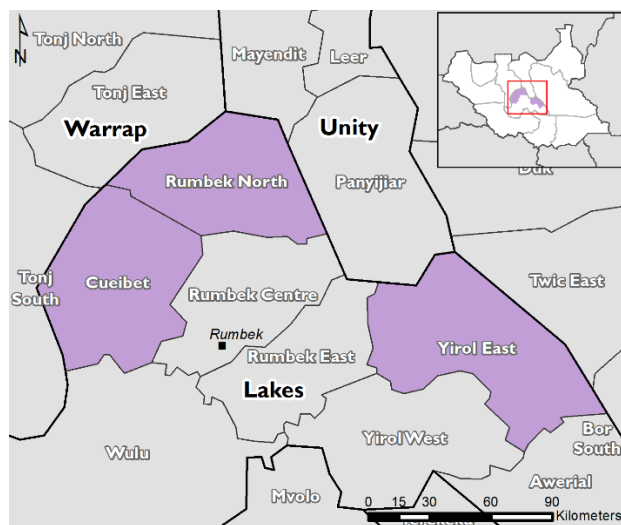
Households' access to livestock products and other food sources remains low due to the absence of livestock from homesteads and high market prices. While FSNMS data indicates 65-70 percent of households' own livestock, key informant information reports more than 80 percent of livestock have been taken to dry-season grazing areas along the bank of Nile and to Western Equatoria state to avoid raids. As a result, the supply of milk and other livestock products are very limited both at the household level and in markets.

Based on two separate FEWS NET assessments conducted in Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East in between February and May, households' stocks were depleted in February and households are relying on wild foods and market purchases. In both Cueibet and Yirol East, markets are functional but have limited volumes of cereal. In Rumbek North, markets have been significantly disrupted by inter-communal conflict and households must walk 12 or more hours to Rumbek Center to access markets. Prices of staple foods remain extremely high: based on the April 2019 market price data in CLiMIS, the price of a kilogram sorghum in Rumbek Central market was 173 SSP, 291 percent higher than a five-year average (Figure 11). The lower price observed in March, and subsequent spike in April, can be attributed to state government interventions in March meant to reduce all food prices that in turn resulted in traders keeping cereals off of official markets, in favor of selling on the black market. In Yirol East, a kilogram of sorghum is 180 SSP, and 160 SSP in Maper of Rumbek North, driven by the spike in prices in Rumbek Centre market, their source market, low production in 2018, and road banditries and illegal checkpoints.

The onset of rains in most parts of Lakes have been late and, according to satellite-derived estimates, rainfall in most areas of Lakes has been 70 to 85 percent of normal. Both key informants and information during FEWS NET's rapid assessments confirm that land preparation has started in many areas, though the planting of main season crops has not occurred due to the delayed onset of rains. The regeneration of pasture and water is also below average.

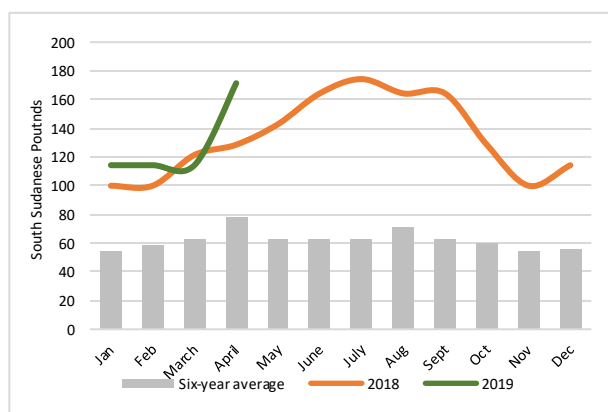
Humanitarian access has somewhat improved due to low levels of armed conflict between February and May. According to WFP's February to April distribution data, humanitarian food assistance reached around 19,000 people per month in Rumbek North, an estimated 30 percent of the population, with under 20 percent of their kilocalorie needs. In Cueibet, no

Figure 10. Areas of Concern: Cueibet, Rumbek North, and Yirol East of Lakes



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 11. Retail price of a kilogram of sorghum, Rumbek Center



Source: CLiMIS data

beneficiaries were reached between February and April. In Yirol East, an estimated 24,000 people, roughly 22 percent of the population, was reached with under 20 percent of their estimated kilocalorie needs.

In Cueibet, a SMART survey conducted by ACF in April found that 56 percent of households reported poor FCS, 52 percent reported an HDDS of 0-2, signifying that they consumed 2 or fewer food groups in the past 24 hours, and 24 percent reported severe hunger on the HHS. The HHS is indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse outcomes, though no breakdown of data was provided and therefore it cannot be determined what percentage of households indicated a score that would be indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). The GAM (WHZ) prevalence was 12.4 percent (10.2-15.0) and the SAM (WHZ) prevalence was 2.6 percent (1.6-4.1). The SMART survey also recorded a non-trauma Crude Death Rate (CDR) of 0.60 and Under Five Death Rate (U5DR) of 1.34. All of the food consumption indicators are indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes while the malnutrition, CDR, and U5DR are indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3). No outcome data has been collected in Rumbek North or Yirol East since the December/January FSNMS. Based on the outcomes collected at that time, the new data available in Cueibet, and information collected by FEWS NET and partners during the ongoing lean season, it is expected Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persist in all three counties, and some households are likely in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in Cueibet.

Assumptions:

In addition to the national-level assumptions above, projected outcomes for the counties of concern in Lakes are based on the following assumptions:

- Although armed conflict is expected to be lower than that of preceding years, it is assumed that inter-communal conflict and cattle raiding are likely to increase through July as livestock continue to be in dry season grazing areas and reduce after with return of livestock to homestead.
- With relatively lower levels of conflict likely, more households than last year are likely to engage in agricultural production.
- Given the forecast for above-average rainfall, flooding is expected in some flood-prone areas, specifically in Yirol East and Cueibet. This is likely to destroy some crops and displace some households. Heavy rainfall and flooding are also likely to seasonally limit humanitarian access and trade flows.
- Based on FEWSNET's integrated price projection for Rumbek Center, the retail price of maize is expected to continue increasing through August, ranging between 130 and 250 SSP/kg, after which prices are expected to decline somewhat seasonally from September to January with the arrival of local sorghum harvests and increased maize supply from Greater Equatoria and Uganda.
- Income from both casual and agriculture labor is expected to be higher than 2018 with greater household movement and higher levels of planting.
- Based on available operation plans, between June and September humanitarian assistance is planned to reach around 17 percent of the population in Rumbek East with a 50 percent ration monthly, slightly over 20 percent of the population with roughly a 50 percent ration monthly in Cueibet, and nearly 16 percent of the population with roughly a 33 percent ration monthly in Yirol East. GFD and FFA distributions is not currently planned for October to January for these counties.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Through the July/August peak of the lean season, households will lack cereal stocks, have limited milk availability, and face extremely high food prices. Many will rely on wild foods and fish which will be increasingly available during the rainy season, though this will be insufficient to meet their basic food needs. Humanitarian assistance will also play a key role in mitigating more severe outcomes among recipients, though it is expected many households will engage in coping strategies including asking community members for support, sending more household members to cattle and fishing camps, and harvesting crops earlier than normal to mitigate food consumption gaps. Considering past trends and seasonal deterioration in food access and availability, and the likelihood of increased morbidity during rainy season, GAM (WHZ) is likely to be 'Serious' in Cueibet and Rumbek North and 'Critical' in Yirol East between June and August. In Cueibet, where planned assistance has changed slightly since May IPC update, it is now expected that assistance will reach about 20 percent or less of the population, and

Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely; Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are likely among some households. In Yirol East and Rumbek North, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are also expected to persist.

With recent lower levels of conflict likely to continue, greater household movement and greater ability to engage in planting will result in higher production than last year and this will lead to some food security improvements during the October to January period. Additionally, with the availability of milk as livestock return to their homesteads and livestock births occur, households' consumption is expected to somewhat improve in all the three areas of concern. Market access will also improve slightly with relatively lower prices. However, given that sources of food will remain low and occasionally disrupted by inter-communal conflict even during this time, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is likely in all counties. 'Serious' levels of acute malnutrition are likely during this time.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

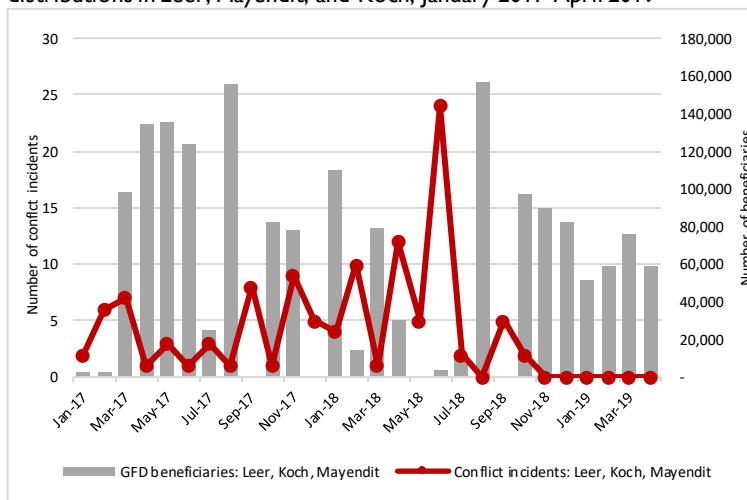
Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
Cueibet, Rumbek North and Yirol East of Lakes	Delay or lack of implementation of the Peace Agreement and formation of unity government, and a subsequent uptick in conflict.	This would disrupt trade flows, restrict access to humanitarian assistance and natural food sources, and lead to further displacement. In the event that violence further restricts households' movement in search of food sources, extreme outcomes would be expected and concern for the possibility of Famine (IPC Phase 5) would increase.
Cueibet, Rumbek North and Yirol East of Lakes	Reduced inter-communal violence	Reduced conflict would likely improve access to assistance, markets wild foods, and fish. Trade flows would also likely improve, resulting in somewhat lower market prices and improved access to market. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are likely.

OTHER AREAS OF CONCERN:

Unity State: Leer, Mayendit, and Koch

Armed conflict has further decreased since December 2018 in central Unity and with the recent peace celebration in Leer by the Opposition and Government in April more IDPs and refugees have returned from Sudan, Malakal PoC, Juba PoCs, and Bentiu PoC. The prevailing relative calm in these areas has also further improved access to previously inaccessible areas, supported the delivery of regular humanitarian assistance (Figure 12), and encouraged trade flow from Sudan and Juba. The trade routes of Juba-Bor-Adok and Kosti-Tonga-Adok have largely recovered, though the number of traders remains low due to concerns of a resurgence of insecurity. Despite lower conflict, households still face difficulty meeting their basic food needs. 2018/2019 production was well below average and 56 percent of households reported that they had already exhausted food stocks by January/February. Households also face significantly high staple food prices. Prices have declined somewhat, though: in May, the price of sorghum was 74 SSP/kg in Leer and 80 SSP/kg in Mayendit. These prices are much lower than those recorded in Juba and Rumbek in April, possibly due to consistent humanitarian assistance deliveries in central Unity. Access to livestock products remains extremely low due to massive livestock looting that occurred in 2015-2016. According to the 23rd FSNMS, only 50.8 percent of households in Koch, 16.3 percent in Leer, and 4.3 percent in Mayendit own livestock, though over 60 percent reported some access to milk, and it is expected livestock products are being shared.

Figure 12. Conflict incidents versus beneficiaries of general food distributions in Leer, Mayendit, and Koch, January 2017-April 2019



Source: WFP distribution data; ACLED data

Data collected during the 2018/2019 post-harvest period showed notable improvement in food security when compared with results during the 2018 lean season, the latter of which followed heavy conflict and the absence of assistance. In the 2018/2019 post-harvest survey, 11 percent of households in Leer reported moderate hunger per the HHS and no households reported severe hunger. In Mayendit 87 percent reported moderate hunger and 3 percent reported severe hunger. In Koch, 61 percent reported moderate hunger and 19 percent reported severe hunger. 28 percent of households in Leer, 73 percent of households in Koch, and 54 percent of households in Mayendit reported poor FCS. Although the FCS is indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4) per the IPC reference table, it is likely this score is indicative of a non-diversified diet rather than large food consumption gaps given heavy reliance on assistance and relatively lower reporting of moderate or severe hunger. FEWS NET's household-level convergence of food consumption and livelihood coping data indicate that Mayendit and Leer were likely in Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) in January. In Koch, where assistance is lower, and outcomes are more severe, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes likely existed. By June, continued humanitarian food assistance in Leer and Mayendit has sustained Crisis (IPC Phase 3!): Roughly 59,000 people in Leer and 52,000 people in Mayendit, estimated at over half of the county populations, are reached with the equivalent of a 50 percent monthly ration. In Koch, roughly 23,000 people are reached also on a 60-day cycle, though this is estimated to be less than 20 percent of the population. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely in Koch.

The assumptions for the most likely scenario noted in the national overview are also applicable to central Unity. Given its importance to the area, it is also noted that access to fishing will likely be limited by fishing kits and high-water levels through October and access will seasonally improve from November onward. The delivery of assistance is also likely to be consistent, though some intermittent disruptions may be expected during the August-September peak of the rainy season.

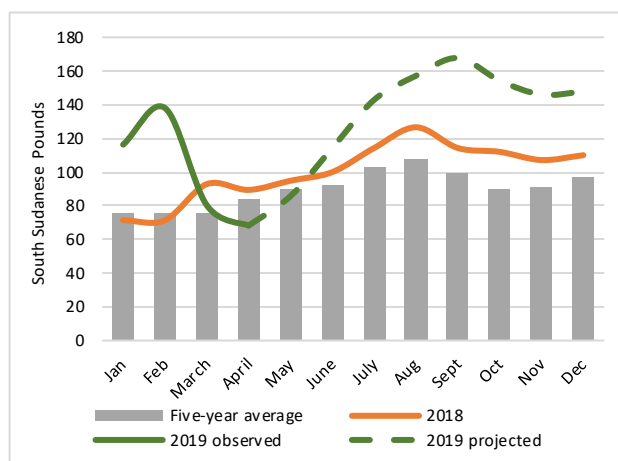
Based on current outcomes and the most likely assumptions, food security is expected to deteriorate through the peak of the lean season in July/August due to limited access to livestock and very poor purchasing power; most households will rely on fish, wild foods, and humanitarian assistance. However, given relative security improvements, it is expected households will generally have free movement to collect wild foods and engage in some fishing. However, food security is expected to improve slightly from October through December due to availability of some dry harvests, fish, vegetables, and some milk. Humanitarian food assistance is expected to continue playing a key role in preventing more extreme outcomes and Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) is expected in Leer and Mayendit. In Koch, where planned assistance levels are relatively lower, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely.

Western Bahr el Ghazal: Wau and Raga

Armed conflict in Wau and Raga has reduced significantly since January 2019 when compared with 2016-2018 conflict levels, and the relative calm has supported improved trade flows and permitted increased access to farmlands, natural resources, markets, and humanitarian assistance. The calm has also supported the return of some IDPs, though isolated conflict persists in some areas and displacement levels remain high, increasing in Wau from around 96,000 people to 104,000 people between January and March and declining in Raga from 18,500 people to 10,000 people over the same time period. Cereal production from 2018/2019 was below average, with the county-level deficit increasing to 15.4 percent from the previous year's 10.4 percent, according to CFSAM. Most households depleted stocks between January and April and are now reliant on markets. Food access has improved somewhat compared to last year: the retail price of sorghum declined by 76 percent from last year, though the decline is likely temporary, and prices still remain extremely high at over 170 percent above the five-year average. This, coupled with the fact that 45-65 percent of households in both counties reported a decline in their income from last year, indicates food access remains very poor despite improvements.

Results from the 23rd FSNMS found that over 80 percent of households in both counties reported moderate hunger per HHS, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3), while 0-1 percent reported severe hunger, and 45-65 percent reported poor FCS. Around 5-

Figure 13. Current and projected retail price of sorghum, Wau



Source: CLiMIS data; FEWS NET projection

15 percent reported engaging in coping strategies due to a lack of food or money to buy food which would be considered indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3), including harvesting crops earlier than normal, while roughly 35-45 percent reported currently engaging in coping strategies typically indicative of Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Since this time period, it is expected that food security has improved slightly due to lowering conflict and improved access to markets, natural resources, and humanitarian food assistance, though outcomes remain severe as the lean season progresses and food sources are seasonally low. Between February and April, WFP distributed food assistance to roughly 83,000 people monthly in Wau with over 50 percent of their kilocalorie requirements. Although the majority of this assistance going to the IDP sites, some rural populations are also being reached and overall over 25 percent of the population is likely receiving assistance. No households were reached in February and March in Raga, though roughly 27,000 people were reached in April with over half of their kilocalorie needs. Overall, it is expected that Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is likely in Raga and Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) is likely in Wau.

The assumptions for the most likely scenario noted in the national overview are also applicable to Wau and Raga, including the expectation that production will be better than last year but below average and that staple food prices will remain above the five-year average (Figure 13). Humanitarian food assistance is planned for roughly 20,000 people a month, roughly 20 percent of the population, with a 50 percent ration, between June and August in Raga. No HFA is currently planned for October to January. In Wau, over 100,000 people are planned to receive HFA, roughly 30 percent of the population, between June and September, with over 50 percent of their kilocalorie needs. Roughly 50,000 people are planned to receive HFA monthly between October and January with over 50 percent of their kilocalorie needs. Based on past trends in these counties, most of this assistance is likely to be distributed.

Based on current outcomes and these assumptions, it is expected that food security will further deteriorate through the July/August 2019 peak of the lean season, though Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in Raga and Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) in Wau will persist as relatively lower conflict will allow households to collect wild foods and access markets, though high food prices and no food stocks continue to limit normal access. Food security will improve between September 2019 and January 2020 when households have access to harvests; cereal production in 2019/20 is expected to be somewhat better than in 2018/19. However, current outcomes are still expected to persist during this time in both counties due to increased number of returnees and continued high number of IDPs, many of whom who are not expected to have access to a harvest, and the fact that many poor households will also continue to lack access to sufficient food to meet their basic needs.

Eastern Equatoria State: Kapoeta East

According to data on food consumption and livelihood change collected by the FSNMS between December and January, 28 percent of households reported a poor FCS, 82 percent reported moderate hunger on the HHS, and 31 percent reported an rCSI > 18. Broadly these data are indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes. Over 50 percent of households reported currently engaging in at least one coping strategy indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Since this time, it is expected outcomes have remained broadly similar, though with slight deterioration driven by inter-conflict and lack of access to livestock products during the dry season.

Localized inter-communal conflict continues to displace households and limit access to grazing areas, markets, and gathering wild foods in Jie and Mogos of Kapoeta East. Recent inter-communal conflict between Jie and Murle in early and mid-May resulted in loss of lives, abduction of women and children, loss of thousands of livestock, and displacement of more than 20,000 people. Although the trade route from Kenya to Kapoeta is operating at near normal levels, food prices remain extremely high and according to data collected by FEWS NET during a rapid assessment in May, the price of 1 kg of maize has further increased by 18 percent as compared to last month. The delay and below-average performance of rains this season has delayed land preparation and planting in many areas. Poor rainfall has also delayed the restoration of pasture and water conditions and most livestock remain away from homesteads in dry season grazing areas at this time when livestock would typically have returned to homesteads and milk for consumption would be available. Despite conflict and the looting of some assistance, WFP reached roughly 68,000 people per month in March and April with a ration equivalent to over 50 percent of beneficiaries' kilocalorie needs. This assistance has likely mitigated more severe outcomes and Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) persists.

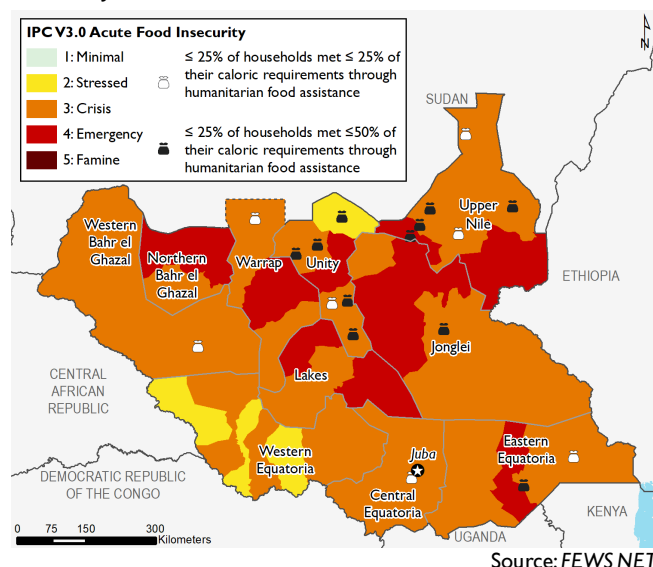
The assumptions for the most likely scenario noted in the national overview are also applicable to Kapoeta East. In addition, localized fighting/cattle raiding is expected to continue in Jie and Mogos as cattle migrate to the bordering areas of Buma in search of pasture and water. Overall, access to milk and livestock sales will remain lower than normal due to the delayed return of livestock to homesteads until July. Cereal prices are likely to be higher through August, driven by scarcity of foreign currency for imports and low market supply, but gradually decline through December 2019 due to food from harvest.

From June to September, food security is expected to deteriorate further driven by complete exhaustion of own food stock resulting from poor harvest in 2018, high market prices, and very low access to livestock products. With the limited income from sales of livestock, gold, and natural resource products, households' access to cereals will remain very low. Furthermore, the displaced and poor households in Mogos, Kauto, and Jie who lack physical access to markets and experienced localized insecurity are likely to face even larger consumption gap and engage in coping strategies to reduce food consumption gaps. Given planned assistance through September and the likelihood of delivery, Crisis (IPC Phase 3!) is likely through September. Between October 2019 to January 2020, food security outcomes are expected to improve due to expected dry harvest, and increased availability and consumption of livestock products, though below-average cereal production and high market prices for cereals will continue to limit food access and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are likely.

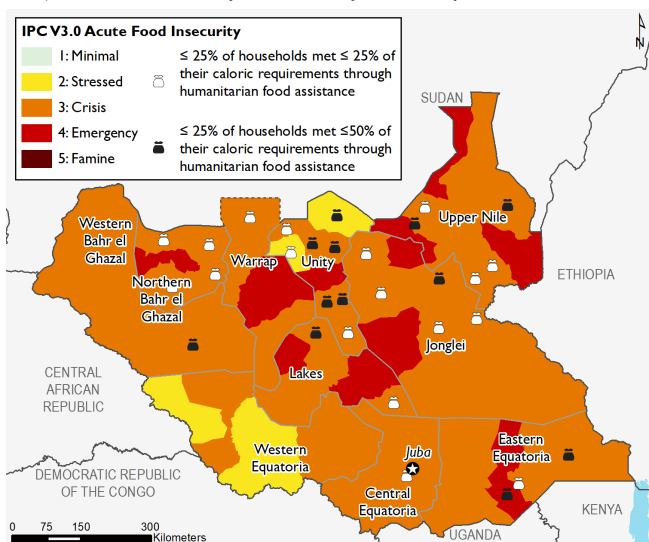
MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE*

Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.0 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. ☐ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). ☑ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

Current, June 2019

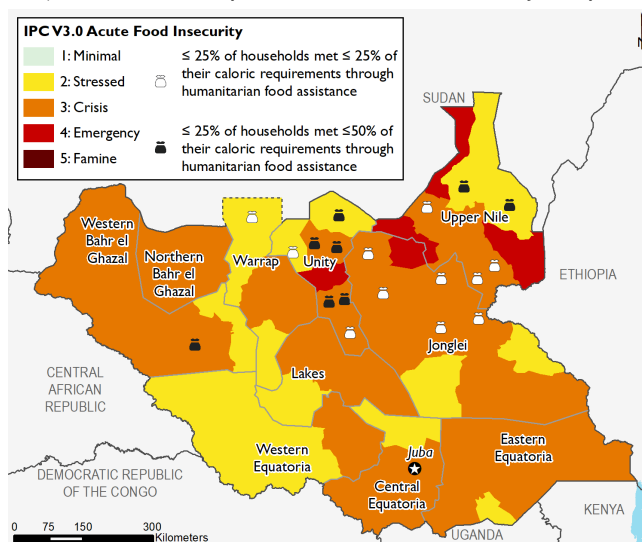


Projected food security outcomes, June to September 2019



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2019 to January 2020



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)